MCP

Title:
Imaginary Friend

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(*Jimmy starts off the scene by looking frantically around his room for an object – it's not clear what he's looking for but he finds some fairly unpleasant things while he's looking – Henry, Jimmy's imaginary friend, sneaks up behind him, scaring Jimmy half to death*)

Henry: Looking for this?

Jimmy: Why do you have my cell phone?

Henry: I was playing Candy Smash. I have to entertain myself somehow while you're gone and your mom turns off the wifi during the day.

Jimmy: I need that phone! How am I supposed to be able to send messages to cute girls during the day if you have my phone?

Henry: Psssh, you don't talk to cute girls. You call that Emma girl cute? I have news for you, buddy, she is not cute.

Jimmy: She's cute. Look, I don't need my imaginary friend giving me advice on the cuteness of the girls I talk to.

Henry: Then what do you need an imaginary friend for?

Jimmy: We are not having this conversation again. I need you to be here. End of story.

Henry: Why not? Why can't we have this conversation? Jimmy, Jim, can I call you Jim? Of course I can call you Jim, I can call you whatever I want to, I'm imaginary. You need to move on with your life! You're….you're….how old are you now?

Jimmy: I don't see why that matters.

Henry: But it *does* matter! It does! You have to be at least…..21?

Jimmy: 21?! I can't even drive and I'm still in high school, but you think I'm old enough to buy beer.

Henry: How am I supposed to know these things?! You shave. You like girls. I don't know when these things are supposed to happen. I'm an imaginary friend. Usually we deal with lost teeth and monsters. Not cute girls and learning to drive. You do remember that I can't go anywhere until you let me go, right?

Jimmy: I remember.

Henry: Ok….so….I have an idea. How about we practice? You know, like we did when you had to tell your mom that you broke her tablet.

Jimmy: Ok….wait….*I* broke mom's tablet….That was you, remember? I had to take the fall for you that time. You were the one who dropped it into the aquarium because the fish looked bored.

Henry: They really should put a warning label on those things.

Jimmy: I'm not going to practice. No sir, you are not going anywhere. Who else am I supposed to play video games with? I'm an only child, in case you forgot.

Henry: Here we go again! I'm an only child, feel sorry for me. Poor, poor little Jimmy, here is the world's tiniest saxophone, playing a sad, sad song for you.

Jimmy: Isn't it supposed to be a violin?

Henry: Imaginary friends have saxophones, not violins. Do you hear it? It sounds like Kenny G. (hums soothing saxophone music) Are you ready to practice letting me go now?

Jimmy: No.

Henry: How about now?

Jimmy: No.

Henry: How about now? Now? How about now?

Jimmy: Stop!

Henry: Can't help myself. I'm supposed to be having conversations about kid things, not convincing an oversized manchild that he should be letting his *imaginary* friend go. I don't think you realize the seriousness of this situation that we find ourselves in.

Jimmy: What do you mean?

Henry: Well, for starters, you're not seven anymore.

Jimmy: I had noticed.

Henry: Yes, and most um, how do I say this politely? Oh I don't care. Most normal children give up their imaginary friends when they're….at most…seven.

Jimmy: So I'm a late bloomer. My mom always says that I shouldn't be in any rush to grow up because growing up is a terrible thing that should be avoided at all costs.

Henry: So that's what this is about.

Jimmy: Well, what would you do in my situation? I don't want to pay bills, taxes, get married. Commitment sounds awful and scary and I don't want to do it. My friend's brother lives in their basement and he's almost 40 and he seems really happy.

Henry: Happy or delusional?

Jimmy: Is there a difference?

Henry: C'mere, let me take a look at you.

Jimmy: Why?

Henry: Humor me. We've been friends for most of your life. You kinda owe me.

Jimmy: Fine.

Henry: Stand here. Recite your alphabet backwards.

Jimmy: What? Why?

Henry: Nevermind there are other ways I can tell.

Jimmy: Tell what. Why are you looking at me like that?

Henry: Yessir, I think I can officially diagnose you.

Jimmy: Diagnose me? How are you in any way qualified to diagnose me, Henry?

Henry: Excuse me? That's *doctor* Henry, I didn't go to imaginary medical school to be called just "Henry."

Jimmy: Ok, *doctor* Henry. What is your prognosis? Am I going to die?

Henry: Do you want the good news or the bad news?

Jimmy: Let's start with the good news. You know I don't like bad news. Bad news means mom is making "creative" tacos again.

(They both shudder at the thought of mom's tacos)

Henry: The good news is that you are old enough that you don't need me anymore.

Jimmy: How is that good news?

Henry: I didn't say it was good news for you, silly. Now the bad news is that you won't let me go because you are suffering from *Peter Pan* syndrome.

Jimmy: You made that up. You have to have made that up.

Henry: No, it's an official imaginary diagnosis. Basically it means that, like Peter Pan, you refuse to grow up. How this affects me is that I am an imaginary friend who is stuck with a person who is no longer a child but still wants to be one. This is a problem because I have absolutely zero experience with the trials and suffering of teenagers. You are a teenager right?

Jimmy: Yes, at least we can agree on that. But I don't have this….whatever it is…syndrome. I just don't see the need to let go of my childhood.

Henry: But….I have a cure for you.

Jimmy: You have a cure for something that I don't actually have.

Henry: Yes. No…you do have it, even if you won't admit it. You know there are support groups for people like you?

Jimmy: Really? Support groups for people with obnoxious imaginary friends.

Henry: No, silly, support groups for people who refuse to grow up. It's called Twitter.

Jimmy: I should never have let you get online.

Henry: Hey, what else am I supposed to do while you go live your glamorous high school life?

Jimmy: Glamorous? Ha…no…you have no idea.

Henry: Come here, gather around the therapy couch.

Jimmy: You want to give me counseling now?

Henry: (with a pad of imaginary paper) Now, tell me, how long are you planning to be single and childlike?

Jimmy: I don't see where you're going with this. I can have an imaginary friend and date girls and be popular in school.

Henry: Oh, right, let's see how well that goes. Let me describe to you how this one plays out. Oh, hi, cute girl #437, I want to take you home to meet my imaginary friend. What's that? Oh no, I'm not crazy. I just want to remain a tiny infant forever.

Jimmy: You're hilarious. Get comfortable, you're not going anywhere.

Henry: Maybe I'm not. But I do know I can help you want to be an adult someday.

Jimmy: I don't think you can, but I suppose I can't stop you from trying.

Henry: Nope, you can't. So prepare yourself for "intensive training in adulting"!! Here is your first scenario. It's dinner time….what do you do?

Jimmy: Wait until Mom calls me to the table and then I eat whatever she made.

Henry: Wrong! What do you want to eat? You want these Oreos?

Jimmy: Yes, but they'll spoil my dinner.

Henry: You're an adult. You can eat the Oreos. You can eat a whole package of Oreos. Oreos can *BE* dinner.

Jimmy: Really?! They can??

Henry: Yes. And this is only one of the perks of being an adult.

Jimmy: There's more??

Henry: Yes. So much more.

Jimmy: Like what?

Henry: What time do you have to be home at night?

Jimmy: 11:30 or mom turns the hose on me when I get home and I'm grounded for a week.

Henry: When you're an adult there is no curfew.

Jimmy: No curfew?

Henry: No curfew.

Jimmy: That. Is. Amazing!

Henry: I know, right??

Jimmy: Being an adult is starting to not sound so bad.

Henry: I haven't even told you the best part yet.

Jimmy: There's something better than Oreos for dinner and no curfew??

Henry: Yes.

Jimmy: What could possibly be better than cookies for dinner and staying out as late as I want to?

Henry: Picture this: No rules. You make the rules.

Jimmy: I make the rules.

Henry: All of them.

Jimmy: Whoa…..so I get to decide what I want to do and when I want to do it.

Henry: Yes.

Jimmy: Wait…this all sounds too good to be true. What's the catch?

Henry: What's the what?

Jimmy: The catch, there's always a catch with something good like this.

Henry: Sure there's other things, things you might be afraid of, but the Oreos….think of all the wonderfully bad dinner decisions there are to be made. And money, you make money, lots and lots of money that you can spend on wifi and Netflix.

Jimmy: Money? Doesn't that mean I have to have a job?

Henry: Hush, don't worry about such trivial things as a job. Just focus on the money.

Jimmy: Money.

Henry: And cookies as far as the eye can see. Are you with me??

Jimmy: But being an adult means that I have to let you go right? Why can't I have all of those things and have you too?

Henry: You don't need me anymore. Trust me, there's nothing more embarrassing than being an adult and having an imaginary friend. I'm a third wheel on dates. It'll look like you're talking to yourself. I'm a terrible college roommate. I've never been a college roommate, but I know I'd be the worst.

Jimmy: I suppose you're right.

Henry: It won't be so bad, pal. Maybe when I'm gone you'll spend more time talking to real people.

Jimmy: You are real people to me.

Henry: That's touching, it really is…but don't you think there's a child out there that needs me just a little more than you do?

Jimmy: But I'll miss you. Who will laugh at my jokes? Who will tell me it's all going to be ok when I'm scared?

Henry: You're a big boy now. You can deal. And I'll leave the monster spray for you.

Jimmy: Promise?

Henry: Promise.

Jimmy: All right, I can do this. I can adult.

Henry: That's the spirit. I'll just grab my things. (*He grabs nothing*). Ok, see you around.

Jimmy: That's it. That's goodbye?

Henry: Yeah, see ya.

Jimmy: Won't I ever be able to see you again?

Henry: Sure, sure you will. Just like when Patches went to that farm in country.

Jimmy: Uh, Henry, Patches died. We buried him in the backyard. I just told you that Patches went to a farm to make you feel better.

Henry: You did that. For me? Thanks, pal. See, you're one step closer to being an adult already.

Jimmy: Thanks. See ya.

Henry: Bye.

(*Henry leaves and Jimmy sits for a few minutes, trying to sike himself up to be an adult*)

Jimmy: Wait, Henry, I've changed my mind. Henry?? Henry.

Henry: Sorry, no takesie backsies.

Jimmy: Fine. I'll be ok. Just go.

Henry: If I were to stay….

Jimmy: Yes….

Henry: Promise me you won't bury me in the backyard.

Jimmy: Ok, I promise.

Henry: I can't leave you when you have that sad look on your face. Maybe I'll stick around for a while, just, you know….until you get used to the whole adult thing.

Jimmy: That sounds good. Let's go find some Oreos. We can pretend to be adults and have them for dinner.

Henry: Sounds like a plan.